

COVER LETTER

July 4, 2026

Editor-in-Chief
Frontiers in Dentistry

Dear Editor-in-Chief,

On behalf of all authors, we are pleased to submit our original research article entitled "Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy and Spatial Working Memory After Repeated Gingival *Porphyromonas gingivalis* Exposure in Rats" for consideration for publication in *Frontiers in Dentistry*.

This experimental animal study evaluates temporal changes in Y-maze spontaneous alternation after repeated gingival *Porphyromonas gingivalis* exposure followed by hyperbaric oxygen therapy (HBOT). It addresses the oral-systemic implications of periodontal pathogen exposure and the potential relevance of HBOT to cognitive-related behavioral outcomes. Because the study did not include a *Porphyromonas gingivalis* exposure-only group, the increase in spontaneous alternation after the HBOT phase is not interpreted as proof of an HBOT-specific causal effect.

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published previously in whole or in part, is not under consideration by another journal, and will not be submitted elsewhere while it is under consideration by Frontiers in Dentistry. All authors have read and approved the submitted manuscript and agree with its submission. The manuscript contains no reproduced copyrighted material that requires permission from another copyright holder.

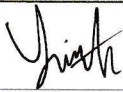
All information regarding ethical approval, funding, conflicts of interest, and the use of generative AI for language editing and manuscript formatting has been disclosed in the manuscript. The authors have reviewed and verified the final scientific content, data presentation, citations, and conclusions and accept full responsibility for the submitted work.

Authors' Contributions

- **Study concept and design:** Yoifah Rizka Wedarti, Soetjipto, and Agung Krismariono.
- **Literature review; experimental/laboratory procedures; data collection and curation; manuscript preparation:** Yoifah Rizka Wedarti.
- **Statistical analysis and interpretation:** Yoifah Rizka Wedarti and Soetjipto.
- **Editing, critical review, supervision, and final approval:** Yoifah Rizka Wedarti, Soetjipto, and Agung Krismariono.

Author Signatures

The authors below confirm the declarations and contribution statements in this cover letter.

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Sincerely,

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